

wildtag.ai

Quick reference guide

This is a condensed cheat sheet for running a project through wildtag.ai from start to finish. For full detail on any setting, see the full manual.

The four tabs, in order

- **Run** — process a folder of camera trap images and tag detections.
- **Validate** — review and correct wildtag's species labels.
- **Distribute** — package validation batches into zips for volunteers, merge their corrections back, and export favourite images.
- **Summary** — stats, species counts, the confusion matrix once validated, and a button to launch the map of detection locations.

The map (detection locations, needs deployment metadata) now opens in your web browser from the **Launch map** button on the Summary tab, rather than as a separate tab.

One-time setup

1. Download and unzip the wildtag.ai installer, then run **wildtag_Setup.exe**. No administrator rights are needed.
2. Launch wildtag from the desktop or Start Menu shortcut.
3. If you have an NVIDIA GPU, accept the one-time prompt to install GPU-enabled PyTorch when offered. This is optional but meaningfully faster.

Standard project workflow

1. **Run** tab: Browse to your project folder (the one containing an images\ subfolder).
2. Choose a species classifier. **DeepFaune** (UK and European wildlife) is bundled and fast. **SpeciesNet** (global) downloads on first use and needs a GPU to be practical, see the note below.
3. Set your confidence thresholds and geographic filter if relevant.
4. Choose CPU or GPU under Performance, and set CPU threads if using CPU.
5. Leave "Sort images into species folders" checked, this is what Validate and Distribute both need.
6. Click **Run wildtag** and wait. Progress and any issues appear in the log below.
7. **Validate** tab: browse to validation\ inside your project, review each species folder, correct any wrong labels.
8. **Distribute** tab (optional): package validation batches into volunteer zips. Max images per zip is configurable, small (default 250) for emailing, large for handing over on a hard drive.
9. When volunteer zips come back, merge their corrections back in via the same Distribute pane.
10. **Summary** tab: review overall stats and the confusion matrix once validation is complete, and launch the map if you have deployment metadata.

Choosing a model

- **DeepFaune v1.4** — recommended for UK and European wildlife. Bundled, works offline, fast on any computer.
- **SpeciesNet** — global coverage. Downloads its model files (about 500 MB) the first time you select it. It is a GPU-scale model: on a computer without a graphics card it is very slow (often 10+ seconds per image), so a large project could take many hours. wildtag warns you and offers DeepFaune instead when you pick SpeciesNet on a machine with no GPU.

Processing device

- **CPU** — always available, slower. Set threads under Performance, leave one free for the rest of your computer.
- **GPU** — requires an NVIDIA card. If wildtag says "No NVIDIA GPU detected" but you have one, it will offer to install GPU PyTorch automatically on next launch.

If a GPU install completes but wildtag still shows CPU only, this usually means the NVIDIA driver needs updating. Update it from [nvidia.com/drivers](https://www.nvidia.com/drivers), then delete `wildtag_settings.json` in the install folder to have wildtag check again.

Validate tab tips

- **Green box** — the detection you're reviewing.
- **Expand button** (corner of each tile) — opens that image large, fitted to your screen. Click it or press Esc to close.
- **Amber box** — another detection in the same photo, shown for context, no action needed.
- **Not listed? Add a label** — if the right species isn't in the correction list, add it here; it stays available for the rest of the project.
- **Mark batch complete** — do this once you've been through every image in that batch.

If something looks wrong

- **App won't open** — launch it from the desktop or Start Menu shortcut. If it still won't start, reinstall from the downloaded installer.
- **GPU install loops or fails** — see the driver note above, this is almost always a driver, not a wildtag, issue.
- **SpeciesNet is very slow** — expected on a computer without a GPU. Switch to DeepFaune for UK and European wildlife.
- **A run was interrupted** — reopen the project; wildtag offers to finish building the validation folders, keeping already-sorted images.
- **Summary asks you to browse to results_with_ids.csv** — make sure you've selected your project folder in the Run tab first.
- **Still stuck** — check the full manual, or reach out to the project lead (css6@st-andrews.ac.uk).